New Delhi by India Foundation, a ruling party–affiliated advocacy think tank. For the text of his speech, see Nepal Foreign Affairs, Government of Nepal (2018), "'Nepal-India Relations in 21st Century' (Full Text of Prime Minister KP Oli's Speech in Civic Reception by India Foundation)," 8 April. Accessed 7 April 2020. http://nepalforeignaffairs.com/nepal-india-relations-in-21st-century-full-text-prime-minister-kp-olis-speech-in-civic-reception-by-india-foundation/.

22 Muni, S. D. (2018), "Sri Lanka's Crisis: Conflicts of Class and Power," *ISAS Insights*, No. 523, 26 November. Accessed 7 April 2020. www.isas.nus.edu.sg/wp-content/uploads/2018/11/ISAS-Insights-No.-523-Sri-Lankas-Crisis.pdf.

23 Mathur, Amitabh (2019), "China's Outreach to the Buddhist World." Unpublished policy paper. February.

24 Modi, Narendra (2015), "PM's Address at 'Samvad': Global Hindu-Buddhist Initiative on Conflict Avoidance and Environment Consciousness," *NarendraModi.in*, 3 September. Accessed 7 April 2020. www.narendramodi.in/text-of-pm-s-address-atsamvad-global-hindu-buddhist-initiative-on-conflict-avoidance-and-environment-consciousness-290614.

25 For instance, the budget for 2018–19 was an increase of nearly 1000 crore rupees in the aid budget for neighbours, but it was lowered to less than the previous year's allocations in the revised estimates. The bulk of this assistance, around 48 percent, goes to Bhutan, leaving only 12 percent for Nepal and around 3 percent each for Bangladesh and Sri Lanka.

26 Poindexter, Gregory B. (2018), "Nepal Prime Minister to 'Revive' 1200 MW Budhi Gandaki Project," *HydroReview*, 21 February. Accessed 7 April 2020. www.hydroworld.com/articles/2018/02/nepal-prime-minister-to-revive-1-200-mw-budhi-gandaki-project.html.

27 *The Business Line* (2018), "India Will Operate Mattala Airport As a Joint Venture with Sri Lanka," 6 July. Accessed 7 July 2018. www.thehindubusinessline.com/economy/logistics/india-to-operate-mattala-airport-in-sri-lanka/article24347909.ece.

28 As quoted in *The Times of India* (2019) "Hambantota Port Not in Chinese Hands: Lanka PM," 8 April, p. 14.

29 Byron, Rejaul Karim and Adhikary, Tuhin Shubhra (2019), "First Indian Line of Credit: 8 Yrs Gone, Only 51pc Utilised," *The Daily Star*, 21 February. Accessed 7 April 2020. www.thedailystar.net/frontpage/news/first-indian-line-credit-8yrs-gone-only-51pc-utilised-1705219.

30 Xavier, Constantino (2017), "India's 'Like Minded' Partnerships to Counter China in South Asia," *Carnegie India*, 11 September. Accessed 7 April 2020. https://carnegieindia.org/2017/09/11/india-s-like-minded-partnerships-to-counter-china-in-south-asia-pub-73079.

31 US$500 million support to Nepal for improving connectivity in the Indo-Pacific region approved in August 2017 may be mentioned here. See Bagchi,